

Southern Rivers Water Authority

Request for Quote (RFQ)

Cloud Migration and Cyber Security Uplift Program

RFQ Reference: SRWA-RFQ-2026-031

Issued: 29 September 2026

Closing time: 2:00 pm AEDT, Friday 23 October 2026

Lodgement: electronically through NSW eTendering

This RFQ is issued to suppliers appointed to the Authority's ICT Professional Services Panel. The Authority is a New South Wales state-owned water utility.

1. Introduction and background

1.1 Southern Rivers Water Authority (the Authority) provides drinking water and wastewater services to 420,000 customers across the Southern Rivers region of New South Wales.

1.2 The Authority operates 180 business applications from two ageing on-premises data centres. The lease for the primary data centre expires in June 2027 and will not be renewed.

1.3 A 2026 internal audit assessed the Authority at Essential Eight Maturity Level 1 for most mitigation strategies and recommended uplift to Maturity Level 2 by June 2028.

1.4 The Authority is seeking a suitably qualified supplier to plan and deliver the migration of its workloads to a secure cloud landing zone and to uplift its cyber security controls, while building the capability of its internal ICT team.

2. Scope of services

2.1 The services comprise three phases: (a) discovery and migration planning; (b) landing zone build and workload migration; and (c) Essential Eight uplift and transition to operations.

2.2 Lot 1 covers phases (a) and (b). Lot 2 covers phase (c). Respondents may respond to one or both lots.

2.3 The Authority expects the services to commence in January 2027 and to be completed by June 2028.

2.4 Operational technology (SCADA) systems are out of scope, but the supplier must ensure that migration activities do not affect operational technology network segmentation.

3. Requirements

3.1 Mandatory requirements. Respondents must meet each of the following mandatory requirements. A response that does not meet a mandatory requirement may be excluded from further consideration.

M1	The supplier must provide a migration approach that sequences workloads by business criticality and data centre exit dates.
M2	The supplier must design and build a cloud landing zone that is hosted in Australia and aligned with the ASD Information Security Manual (ISM).
M3	All personnel with access to Authority systems must hold or be able to obtain an Australian Government Baseline security clearance.
M4	The supplier must hold current ISO/IEC 27001 certification for its information security management system.
M5	The supplier must provide a named engagement lead with at least ten years of experience delivering cloud migration programs.
M6	The supplier must uplift the Authority to Essential Eight Maturity Level 2 across all eight mitigation strategies and provide evidence of the maturity achieved.
M7	The supplier must maintain professional indemnity insurance of at least \$10 million and public liability insurance of at least \$20 million.
M8	The supplier must provide a transition plan that transfers knowledge to the Authority's internal team and its managed service provider.
M9	The supplier must comply with the Authority's Supplier Code of Conduct and the Modern Slavery Act 2018 (Cth).
M10	All Authority data must remain in Australia at all times, including backups and logs.

3.2 Desirable requirements. The Authority will highly regard respondents who demonstrate the following.

D1	Experience delivering cloud migrations for water, energy or other regulated utilities.
D2	A proven approach to organisational change management and staff capability uplift.
D3	Experience with Microsoft Azure and Microsoft Entra ID in a government context.
D4	The ability to engage an Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander business as a subcontractor or partner.
D5	A method for measuring and reporting benefits realisation throughout the program.
D6	Innovative approaches that reduce the Authority's ongoing cloud running costs.

4. Evaluation criteria

4.1 Responses will be evaluated against the following criteria and weightings.

Criterion	Weighting
Understanding of the Authority's requirements	15%
Proposed approach and methodology	30%
Capability and experience of the proposed team	25%
Relevant experience and case studies	15%
Value for money	15%

4.2 Price will be assessed on a whole-of-life basis. The lowest price will not necessarily be accepted.

4.3 Shortlisted respondents may be invited to present to the evaluation panel in the week commencing 9 November 2026.

5. Submission instructions

5.1 Responses must be lodged electronically through NSW eTendering by the closing time. Late responses will not be accepted.

5.2 The response must not exceed 30 A4 pages, excluding the returnable schedules, CVs and case study appendices.

5.3 Responses must use Arial 11 point font with single line spacing and 2 cm margins.

5.4 Files must be named using the convention SRWA-RFQ-2026-031_[Respondent name]_[Document name].

5.5 Responses must be submitted in PDF format, with the pricing schedule also provided in Microsoft Excel format.

5.6 CVs for key personnel must not exceed two pages each.

5.7 Questions about this RFQ must be submitted through NSW eTendering by 5:00 pm AEDT on Wednesday 14 October 2026. Answers will be published to all respondents.

6. Key dates

Event	Date
RFQ issued	29 September 2026
Industry briefing (online)	10:00 am AEDT, Wednesday 7 October 2026
Deadline for questions	5:00 pm AEDT, Wednesday 14 October 2026
RFQ closing time	2:00 pm AEDT, Friday 23 October 2026
Shortlist presentations	Week commencing 9 November 2026
Contract commencement	18 January 2027

7. Pricing and commercial conditions

7.1 Respondents must complete Returnable Schedule 3 – Pricing Schedule in the Excel format provided.

7.2 Lot 1 must be priced as a fixed price with payment against milestones. Lot 2 may be priced as capped time and materials.

7.3 Daily rates must not exceed the respondent's ICT Professional Services Panel ceiling rates and must be quoted exclusive of GST.

7.4 The Contract will be based on the Authority's standard Professional Services Agreement. Liability will be capped at two times the contract value.

7.5 Any departures from the Professional Services Agreement must be identified in Returnable Schedule 4 – Statement of Departures. Departures not identified will be taken to be accepted.

7.6 The supplier must be able to invoice monthly in arrears, with payment within 20 business days of a correctly rendered invoice.

8. Returnable schedules

8.1 Respondents must complete and submit the following returnable schedules:

Returnable Schedule 1 – Respondent Details and Declaration

Returnable Schedule 2 – Referees (three referees for similar engagements)

Returnable Schedule 3 – Pricing Schedule

Returnable Schedule 4 – Statement of Departures

Returnable Schedule 5 – Conflict of Interest Declaration

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